project.org

STUDENT HANDOUT

GREEN LEVEL
MORE SUPPORT

Coin Detectives

Grades 3–4 · Real or Replica?

ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

The coins in *In Their Hands* were spent and held in the years of the Gospels. Eight are genuine. Three are museum-quality replicas, honest copies labeled as copies. But how does an expert know an ancient coin is real? Today you are a coin detective.

01 PART 1 Spot the difference

One of these is a real widow's mite, the tiny coin of Mark 12:41–44. The other is a modern fake. Look at both, then check every clue you can see.

REAL OR REPLICA? · WIDOW'S MITE · LEPTON



COIN A



COIN B

CLUE	COIN A	COIN B
Rough, uneven and off-center		
Clean, neat and perfect		
Worn and old-looking		
Sharp, even letters and shapes		

The fake is Coin (A) or Coin (B) (circle one)

Expert clue: a real lepton was a cheap, everyday coin, made fast and crude. The fake is *too* good. "If a lepton looks perfect, be suspicious."

PART 2

02 Which clue helped you most?

Finish the sentence: **I know the fake is a fake because...**

PART 3

03 A coin that is evidence



CASE 7 · GENUINE

The coin of Pontius Pilate

Pilate was the Roman governor who put Jesus on trial. He had this coin made in 29/30 AD, within a few years of the Passion. Some people once wondered if Pilate was real. In 1961 a stone with his name was found — but his coins had been evidence all along.

Who had this coin made? In what year? What does it help show about the world the Gospels describe?

PART 4

04 Put the coins in order

These four coins go with four Gospel stories. Write **1, 2, 3, 4** in the boxes, from the first story to the last.

☐



Porcius Festus
59–62 AD
Paul appeals to Caesar
Acts 25:12

☐



Augustus Caesar
5–4 BC
Jesus is born in Bethlehem
Luke 2:1

☐



Herod Agrippa I
41–44 AD
Peter is seized
Acts 12:3

☐



Pontius Pilate
29/30 AD
Jesus is put on trial
Matthew 27:24

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

Look at a coin from home with a magnifying glass. Is it worn on its highest points? Then tell your family about Pilate's coin, and why it is evidence that the world the Gospels describe was a real world.